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**Briefing to the Security Council on the humanitarian situation in Syria**  
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[As delivered]

Madam President,

A better future for Syria remains within reach.

After more than a decade of crisis, there is now a genuine opportunity to help Syrians move from survival towards recovery.

There are clear signs of progress towards recovery, reconstruction and development.

Yet, humanitarian needs remain acute, displacement persists, and conditions for sustainable returns are still uneven across the country.

This moment requires ambition anchored in realism: sustained humanitarian action, political will and investment are essential to help Syrians move beyond emergency assistance and rebuild their lives.

Millions of Syrians remain displaced, both within Syria and abroad. Since December 2024, some 1.6 million refugees and nearly 2 million internally displaced people have returned. As people go back to their communities, access to basic services, protection, and livelihoods is critical. Returns and reintegration must remain safe, voluntary, dignified and sustainable.

Meetings between the Government and UN partners in May mapped out the path forward under the “No Camps, No Tents” vision, focused on protection, service provision and sustainable livelihoods. Alongside the Government’s “Statement of National Recovery Priorities,” this way forward provides a clear national direction for recovery and reintegration.

At the same time, humanitarian operations are delivering – but resources remain insufficient. With more support, much more can be achieved.

In the first quarter of this year, nearly 3,000 communities across the country received humanitarian assistance, including food, nutrition and emergency agriculture support for nearly 2

million people, clean water and sanitation assistance for more than 3 million people, and nearly 3 million treatment courses and 2.3 million medical procedures.

Madam President,

Natural disasters remain a risk to communities across Syria. Recent flooding underscored the vulnerability of communities along the Euphrates. More than 17,600 people were affected, farmland was damaged, and critical infrastructure disrupted.

In coordination with authorities, humanitarian partners responded rapidly, deploying ambulances and boats, reinforcing embankments, protecting farmlands, and delivering critical supplies to families in need.

This was an important test for the evolving humanitarian coordination architecture in Syria. The response demonstrated the value of stronger sub-national coordination, more effective local partnerships, and streamlined processes that enable the UN, humanitarian partners and relevant authorities to act quickly and coherently.

In short, acting as one to save lives.

As the floodwaters receded, the focus has shifted to early recovery and preparedness – repairing infrastructure, supporting farmers, and strengthening disease surveillance.

This is the model we need to build on: responding to immediate needs while helping communities become more resilient to the next shock.

Madam President,

Notwithstanding this progress, the reality for some communities remains fragile, particularly in southern Syria.

In Quneitra Governorate, the effects of conflict, including displacement and damaged infrastructure, are being compounded by repeated military incursions and movement restrictions, as well as the presence of unexploded ordnance.

The situation is highly volatile and nearly 80 per cent of the population is in need of humanitarian assistance.

In As-Sweida Governorate, recent violence has restricted movement, limited access to essential services, and perpetuated cycles of displacement for families unable to return safely. Communities are on the edge, strained and stressed by years of conflict, displacement, degraded services, and poor humanitarian access.

Communities, Madam president, must be protected. Humanitarian access must be unimpeded.

In this environment, more than 13,000 students were unable to sit their final exams this month due to access and administrative constraints.

Behind that number are young people whose education has already been repeatedly disrupted by years of crisis. Syria's recovery depends on ensuring they are not left behind.

This highlights the complexity of the operating environment and the issues facing families, as well as the need for continued engagement with the Government of Syria and support from the international community.

Madam President,

As we approach the mid-year, the \$2.92 billion humanitarian appeal is just 20 per cent funded.

My first ask to this Council is, therefore, clear: help us sustain a humanitarian response that is proving it can deliver. Predictable and flexible funding is essential.

Second, we must support Syria's transition beyond emergency aid by helping address the barriers preventing people from rebuilding their lives. The "No Tents, No Camps vision" is a powerful national goal. Achieving it means investing in the conditions that make solutions possible: protection, social inclusion, demining, basic services, livelihoods, and environmental recovery.

And third, we require sustained investment in recovery and reconstruction, aligned with the Government's "Statement of National Recovery Priorities" and guided by the needs of affected communities. Syria does not need narrow thinking that separates humanitarian response from recovery, or recovery from long-term stability.

We must meet urgent needs today while laying the foundations for lasting stability and prosperity. Development financing, economic recovery and stronger services will be essential to ensuring that Syria's transition is sustainable.

Madam President,

Humanitarians are ready to do their part.

We, too, are adapting: reducing bureaucracy, strengthening partnerships, and putting support closer to the communities we serve.

Committed and fit-for-purpose, the humanitarian community stands ready to meet the moment and the challenges ahead.

Thank you.